Ishkhan Khchoian

Project Manager — Games Production & Live Operations

Yerevan, Armenia · remote, or on-site / hybrid in Yerevan · open to relocation
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English (C1) · Russian (native) · Armenian (native)

PROFILE

Project manager with over six years of running parallel workstreams against dates that cannot move — and a player since 2003 who has lived inside the systems games are built on. I have carried up to 12 complex client projects at once, coordinated 8 specialists, produced live events for audiences up to 3,000, and led teams of up to 20. On the other side of the screen I have raided mythic, held a 4,000+ Raider.IO score and 2,400 arena rating in WoW, and 5,000 MMR in Dota 2 — so progression curves, matchmaking, patch metas and live-service economies are not vocabulary I learned for this application.

I am currently COO of SayWhen.am, an AI voice-agent startup, where I run development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence. I completed an IT project management course through a U.S. Embassy program, am taking the PSM I exam in November 2026, and study game design and QA fundamentals on my own. What I bring is the unglamorous half of production — scope, schedules, dependencies, written process and follow-through — paired with genuine fluency in the product.

CORE SKILLS

- **Production:** project coordination · scope and milestone planning · Gantt charts · Scrum and Kanban · backlog and task tracking · risk and dependency tracking · release and event coordination against fixed dates
- **Team & process:** cross-functional coordination · leading teams up to 20 · vendor management · writing specs, checklists and process documentation · acceptance criteria and quality review · onboarding and training
- **Games:** self-taught game design and QA fundamentals · bug reporting with clean reproduction steps · UX and player-flow thinking · systems and economy literacy across MMO, MOBA, FPS, RTS and F2P mobile
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Miro · Notion · Trello · Monday · Bitrix24 · Google Analytics · Google Workspace · MS Office

GAMES — DOMAIN CREDIBILITY

- **20+ years across genres.** WoW since 2006 (Classic, Burning Crusade, WotLK, Cataclysm), Dota 2, CS 1.6 → CS2, Warcraft III: The Frozen Throne, League of Legends, Battlerite, Terraria; console (The Last of Us, Mortal Kombat, Skate 2/3); F2P mobile (Clash of Clans, Clash Royale, Rush Royale, Boom Beach, Asphalt).
- **Competitive results.** Mythic raiding, 4,000+ Raider.IO and 2,400 arena rating (WoW); 5,000 MMR (Dota 2); Distinguished Master Guardian (CS:GO); 15,000 Premier rating (CS2). Top fragger on my team at a local CS 1.6 tournament.
- **Live-service literacy from the player side.** Seasons and battle passes, matchmaking and rating systems, balance patches and meta shifts, retention and monetization loops in F2P titles — the levers a live game is actually steered with.

EXPERIENCE

COO — SayWhen.am (AI voice-agent startup) Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence: requirements, specification, backlog and priorities, and acceptance of each stage.
- Manage the company’s corporate clients across the full engagement cycle: needs discovery, agreement on scope and timelines, and regular progress reporting during implementation.

Freelance — project and legal work Feb 2026 – present

- Designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): a three-scenario funnel model, budget, payback and decision gates.
- Business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); legal projects — IP assignment for works by popular musicians, a corporate structure for a crypto trader and advice on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia; sale of family real estate.

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.) Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects at a time**, end to end, against fixed external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: a cycle of **strictly six months or less**, new **two- and four-month express tracks**, fewer errors through a shared knowledge base, and a **35% higher success rate**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** and reviewed their work against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Produced live events for audiences of **100 to 3,000** — concerts, festivals, Miro's corporate conference and a touring TV show — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip.
- Owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and the day-of operation. The closest thing to a launch date outside software.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Legal practice — U.S. law firms, Arbitration Court, Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Senior Paralegal at Shamayev Business Law, Paralegal at Bloomrich Law Firm: built the internal training program **Paralegal Academy** (50+ people) and improved the firms' internal processes.
- Judge's Associate: **200+ concurrent cases, 30+ hearings a week**; earlier, contract analysis and claims work at a Bar Association.

Project Manager — SIS LLC (family business) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Managed projects including an **investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — every site delivered **on time and accepted with no defects noted**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites and recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up a regional supply network for the retail business.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.
- **Project Management (PM Club)** — 2023, 52 hours.
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches; on-site final at TUMO Labs, Yerevan (July 2026).
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; humanitarian distribution reaching ~100 families a day.